Finally, Kairon Sahib decided to step in and break the impasse. He spoke to Nimmi's father, whom he knew very well, at great length, convincing him to agree to the match. He explained that both Nimmi and I were determined to marry each other, and if her family continued to object, then what would prevent her from eloping and having a court marriage? We both were of age, so didn't really need parental consent. 'Wouldn't such a step,' he asked, 'be equally harmful to your reputation? Wouldn't it be easier to just say "yes"?'

And so, with the chief minister's intervention, all the hurdles were crossed, and preparations for our wedding began.